



India Inc's Wellness Dividend

Corporate India is investing in personalised welfare programmes for a healthier, more productive workforce

BY KARAN DHAR

Agarwal, Chief Wellness Officer, Tata Steel. “The question was not whether we were providing benefits, but whether employees were actually becoming healthier.”

The company has partnered weight loss start-up Fitterfly, diabetes care platform Freedom from Diabetes, and yoga lessons start-up Habuild to offer lifestyle transformation programmes targeting obesity, diabetes, and other lifestyle diseases.

Tata Steel employs 41,307 people in India while its total workforce, including contract workers and

vendors, across multiple plants and mining operations is around 1,50,000. “We have crafted a complete wellness ecosystem that is location-agnostic, personalised and addresses white-collar employees, blue-collar workers, and contract workers,” says Agarwal.

Employees cite examples of how these programmes have helped them navigate difficult phases in their lives. In August 2024, Dhilip Kumar R., who works in the Product Application Group at Tata Steel, hit a low point. “My blood sugar levels were dangerously high,

I weighed 96 kg, and I felt like my health was slipping out of my control. It was hard to imagine finding a way back. That’s when I was introduced to the Freedom from Diabetes programme through Tata Steel’s wellness team. With their tailored plan, my HbA1c reduced dramatically, and I shed over 30 kgs in just three months. I now wake up energised, feeling like a college student again. This incredible journey has even inspired ten of my colleagues to join. I’m truly grateful for this life-empowering initiative,” says Dhilip.